Legalist principle while criticizing the feudal nature of Confucianism.

Five, in its long history, China has experienced periods of relative insularity interspersed with phases of openness to the outside world and embrace of cosmopolitanism, as we shall see in the next chapter. However, relative insularity has been more dominant, reinforced by the self-sufficient character of the Chinese domestic economy, with international commerce playing a lesser role. In that sense, China's emergence today as the world's largest trading power is unprecedented. However, under Xi Jinping, China may be witnessing a revival of a more domestic-oriented economic strategy, and a perception that the country has to once again contend with a hostile periphery.

Yü Ying-shih, Trade and Expansion in Han China: Study in the Structure of Sino-barbarian Economic Relations, University of California Press, 1967.

For a fascinating account of life in the Tang capital of Changan, see Edward H. Schafer, The Golden Peaches of Samarkand: A Study of Tang Exotics, University of California Press, 1885.